

ENGLISH LANGUAGE

LEVEL B1

Build coherent independent communication across familiar and personal domains

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CEFR-Based English Language Curriculum Designer

Curriculum structure • authentic tasks • projects • differentiation • assessment • portfolio

From everyday autonomy to explanation, narrative and supported argument

Framework note: proficiency progression is grounded in the CEFR-level document supplied by the user. English-specific grammar, phonology, lexical sequencing and tasks are a pedagogical adaptation created for English.

Pedagogical vision - Level B1

A threshold level where learners connect ideas, narrate experiences, explain reasons, solve problems and participate actively in familiar discussions.

1. Exit profile

By the end of B1, the learner can understand the main points of clear standard input on familiar matters; follow straightforward narratives and presentations; produce connected text on topics of personal or social interest; narrate experiences and stories; explain plans and opinions; and interact effectively in most routine situations while asking for clarification when needed.

2. Core competence targets

- Reception: understand main ideas and relevant detail in clear articles, interviews, discussions, narratives, instructions and presentations on familiar topics.
- Production: produce coherent narratives, descriptions, explanations, opinions, summaries, reports, CV/cover-letter style texts and short presentations.
- Interaction: exchange information, express feelings and viewpoints, complain, advise, negotiate solutions and contribute to discussions.
- Mediation: summarise a short article, interview or talk; reformulate key points; relay instructions and help others reach a practical solution.
- Language control: manage narrative tenses, conditionals, passive/reporting structures, relative clauses, modals and a wider range of cohesive devices.

3. Annual progression map

Unit	Theme	Main communicative goal	Signature performance
1	Stories That Shape Us	Tell engaging stories and relate past events with clear chronology.	Record a polished personal or fictional podcast story.
2	Learning, Skills and Future Work	Discuss skills, education pathways and realistic future options.	Create a career portfolio and take part in a mock interview.
3	Planet, Community and Responsibility	Discuss environmental/social issues and propose realistic action.	Design and defend a local sustainability campaign.
4	Media, Technology and Information	Summarise information and discuss how media/technology affect daily life.	Produce a class multimedia news feature.
5	Culture, Identity and Belonging	Discuss cultural products, identity and belonging with reasons.	Curate and present a mini cultural festival or exhibition.
6	Ideas, Debate and Solutions	Build and defend a structured viewpoint on a familiar issue.	Publish the B1 "Young English Speakers' Magazine" and join a forum.

4. Pedagogical principles

- Action-oriented learning: every language focus is linked to a communicative purpose and a visible performance.
- Integrated skills: listening, reading, spoken interaction, spoken production, writing and mediation are combined rather than taught in isolation.
- Spiral progression: key structures and lexical fields reappear with greater complexity and independence.
- Pronunciation for intelligibility: accuracy is developed through rhythm, stress, connected speech and high-value contrasts, without requiring imitation of one single native accent.
- Evidence-based learning: portfolio artefacts, self-assessment and performance tasks document progress across the level.

Unit 1 - Stories That Shape Us

Narrative, memory and personal experience

Communicative outcomes	Narrate events; set background; describe earlier events; express reactions; summarise a story/film/book; ask follow-up questions about experiences.
Grammar & functions	Past simple/past continuous/past perfect; present perfect vs past simple; used to/would for past habits; narrative sequencing; relative clauses review.
Vocabulary	Life events, emotions, relationships, travel incidents, turning points, narrative verbs, adjectives for reactions and atmosphere.
Pronunciation	Past -ed consolidation; weak forms; thought groups; prominence on key narrative information; intonation for suspense and reaction.
Integrated skills	Read a narrative; identify chronology; listen to an anecdote; retell; write a 180-word story; provide peer feedback on clarity and impact.

Learning sequence: tasks and classroom activities

- Story reconstruction from mixed paragraphs.
- “What happened before?” past-perfect inference.
- Personal anecdote speed-sharing.
- Podcast listening: identify hook, sequence, climax and ending.
- Peer editing for tense consistency and cohesive devices.

Authentic performance task

“A Story Worth Telling”: 2-3 minute podcast with clear opening, background, event sequence, reaction and closing reflection.

Differentiation	Implementation
Support	Narrative planner, tense timeline, transition bank, model recording and optional rehearsal with teacher.
Expected level	Coherent story with generally controlled narrative tenses and understandable expressive delivery.
Extension	Use richer viewpoint, reported speech and deliberate pacing; retell the story from another perspective.

Evidence of learning

- I can tell a coherent story using several past tenses.
- I can explain how I felt and why an event mattered.
- I can summarise the plot of a familiar story or film.
- I can use sequencing language to guide a listener.

Suggested resources: learner portfolio; teacher-prepared worksheet; visual/audio prompts; CEFR-aligned coursebook selected by the institution (page references to be mapped locally); age-appropriate dictionary; authentic or semi-authentic media.

Unit 2 - Learning, Skills and Future Work

Education, abilities and career choices

Communicative outcomes	Describe abilities/experience; discuss study/work preferences; write a basic CV/cover letter; give reasons for choices; handle a structured interview.
Grammar & functions	Modals of ability/obligation/advice; gerunds and infinitives; first/second conditional; future forms review; defining/non-defining relative clauses (intro contrast).
Vocabulary	Education, qualifications, skills, jobs, workplaces, applications, strengths, responsibilities, teamwork, career goals.
Pronunciation	Word stress in academic/professional vocabulary; sentence stress in interview answers; linking and weak forms in longer turns.
Integrated skills	Read job/course adverts; identify requirements; write CV/profile and cover email; listen to interviews; conduct an interview and take notes.

Learning sequence: tasks and classroom activities

- Skills inventory and evidence matching.
- Job advert jigsaw: candidate-to-position match.
- STAR-style interview answer practice at B1 simplicity.
- Conditional career scenarios.
- Peer review of CV language and clarity.

Authentic performance task

“My Next Step”: one-page CV/profile, short application message and 4-minute mock interview demonstrating experience, skills and goals.

Differentiation	Implementation
Support	CV template, skill verb bank, interview question list, sentence starters and rehearsal roles.
Expected level	Clear, relevant responses with reasons and appropriate register for a basic application.
Extension	Compare two pathways, negotiate a hypothetical offer and ask thoughtful interviewer questions.

Evidence of learning

- I can describe my skills and experience.
- I can understand the main requirements in a job or course advert.
- I can write a simple professional application text.
- I can explain a future choice and respond in an interview.

Suggested resources: learner portfolio; teacher-prepared worksheet; visual/audio prompts; CEFR-aligned coursebook selected by the institution (page references to be mapped locally); age-appropriate dictionary; authentic or semi-authentic media.

Unit 3 - Planet, Community and Responsibility

Explain problems, causes and possible solutions

Communicative outcomes	Explain a problem; identify cause/consequence; compare solutions; make recommendations; discuss responsibility; express probability and conditions.
Grammar & functions	Passive voice present/past/future basics; zero/first/second conditionals; modals of possibility; cause/consequence/purpose linkers; participle adjectives.
Vocabulary	Environment, climate, waste, energy, transport, community, volunteering, sustainable habits, natural events, civic action.
Pronunciation	Stress in compound nouns; contrastive emphasis for problem/solution; intonation for recommendations; connected speech in conditional clauses.
Integrated skills	Read infographics/articles; listen to a short talk; take notes; discuss evidence; write a problem-solution text; pitch an action plan.

Learning sequence: tasks and classroom activities

- Local issue photo inquiry.
- Cause-consequence chain from data cards.
- Solution ranking with feasibility criteria.
- Passive-voice transformation using real processes.
- Mini town-hall discussion with stakeholder roles.

Authentic performance task

“Change Starts Here”: campaign poster/infographic plus 3-minute group pitch explaining issue, evidence, actions, likely results and individual responsibility.

Differentiation	Implementation
Support	Problem-solution organiser, linker bank, simplified data set, role cards and model pitch.
Expected level	Explain a familiar issue coherently and defend practical recommendations.
Extension	Address objections, compare short/long-term effects and mediate a compromise among stakeholder roles.

Evidence of learning

- I can explain causes and consequences of a familiar issue.
- I can propose and justify practical solutions.
- I can understand the main points of a clear factual article or talk.
- I can use conditionals and passive forms to discuss real situations.

Suggested resources: learner portfolio; teacher-prepared worksheet; visual/audio prompts; CEFR-aligned coursebook selected by the institution (page references to be mapped locally); age-appropriate dictionary; authentic or semi-authentic media.

Unit 4 - Media, Technology and Information

Report, reformulate and evaluate everyday information

Communicative outcomes	Report what someone said; summarise an article/interview; distinguish fact/opinion; describe digital habits and risks; present information from more than one source.
Grammar & functions	Reported speech statements/questions; reporting verbs say/tell/ask/explain; tense backshift basics; passive review; relative clauses; discourse markers for contrast/addition.
Vocabulary	Media, news, social networks, devices, online behaviour, privacy, misinformation basics, technology benefits/risks.
Pronunciation	Chunking in reported information; prominence for source attribution; weak forms in reporting clauses; intonation for quotation vs commentary.
Integrated skills	Read two short sources; compare main points; listen to interview; take notes; write a news summary; conduct and report a short interview.

Learning sequence: tasks and classroom activities

- Headline prediction and verification.
- Fact/opinion sorting.
- Interview chain: ask, note, report.
- Two-source comparison chart.
- Newsroom editorial meeting to choose the most important angle.

Authentic performance task

“Class Newsroom”: 2-3 minute multimedia report combining a short article and interview, with clear source attribution and a balanced conclusion.

Differentiation	Implementation
Support	Note-taking frame, reported-speech conversion guide, source comparison table and scripted interview options.
Expected level	Accurately relay main ideas from two short sources and distinguish personal comment from reported information.
Extension	Identify bias indicators, add a counter-viewpoint and respond to audience questions without notes.

Evidence of learning

- I can report the main points of what someone said.
- I can summarise a short article or interview.
- I can distinguish basic fact from opinion.
- I can explain benefits and risks of familiar technology.

Suggested resources: learner portfolio; teacher-prepared worksheet; visual/audio prompts; CEFR-aligned coursebook selected by the institution (page references to be mapped locally); age-appropriate dictionary; authentic or semi-authentic media.

Unit 5 - Culture, Identity and Belonging

Describe cultural experiences and express nuanced personal reactions

Communicative outcomes	Describe a cultural work/event; express and justify preference; compare traditions; discuss stereotypes carefully; express feelings and degrees of certainty.
Grammar & functions	Modals of deduction (must/might/can't) in present; adjective + preposition patterns; participle adjectives; comparatives; clauses with although/even though/whereas.
Vocabulary	Film, music, literature, art, festivals, identity, tradition, values, feelings, reviews, cultural adjectives.
Pronunciation	Expressive intonation for evaluation; stress shift in word families; linking in contrast clauses; avoiding syllable reduction errors in cognates.
Integrated skills	Read reviews; listen to opinions; compare perspectives; write a review; present a cultural item; mediate key information for classmates.

Learning sequence: tasks and classroom activities

- Culture object mystery: infer origin/use.
- Review language spectrum from neutral to strong.
- Compare two festival descriptions.
- Stereotype vs evidence discussion norms.
- Gallery talk with audience question cards.

Authentic performance task

“Culture in Focus”: curated item/exhibit plus 3-minute presentation describing context, personal evaluation and one comparison with another cultural product.

Differentiation	Implementation
Support	Review frame, opinion language ladder, cultural vocabulary bank and model presentation.
Expected level	Give a clear cultural description and supported personal judgement.
Extension	Discuss interpretation, symbolism and possible audience disagreement; use more nuanced evaluative language.

Evidence of learning

- I can describe and evaluate a cultural product.
- I can compare cultural practices without relying on simple stereotypes.
- I can express feelings and degrees of certainty.
- I can support my opinion with specific reasons or examples.

Suggested resources: learner portfolio; teacher-prepared worksheet; visual/audio prompts; CEFR-aligned coursebook selected by the institution (page references to be mapped locally); age-appropriate dictionary; authentic or semi-authentic media.

Unit 6 - Ideas, Debate and Solutions

Argue simply, respond to others and reach conclusions

Communicative outcomes	State a position; organise reasons; agree/disagree politely; ask for clarification; propose solutions; summarise another person's point; reach a conclusion.
Grammar & functions	Conditionals review; wish/if only (intro for present situations); modals should/could/might; discourse markers for argument; reported speech review; gerund-participle clauses at basic level.
Vocabulary	Opinion, agreement/disagreement, evidence, solutions, community issues, education, technology, environment, culture and youth concerns.
Pronunciation	Turn-taking intonation; polite disagreement stress; pausing before key points; discourse stress in mini-presentations.
Integrated skills	Read a short argumentative text; identify claim/reasons/conclusion; discuss in groups; write an opinion article; summarise opposing views.

Learning sequence: tasks and classroom activities

- Claim-evidence-reason matching.
- Opinion line with mandatory justification.
- Clarification strategy cards ("Do you mean...?").
- Mini-debate with rotating moderator.
- Magazine editorial workshop and peer review.

Authentic performance task

"The Young English Speakers' Magazine": each student contributes an article/interview/review, then participates in a class forum defending one recommendation.

Differentiation	Implementation
Support	Argument planner, useful disagreement stems, model article, vocabulary bank and moderator prompts.
Expected level	Organise a clear viewpoint with reasons and respond appropriately to a different opinion.
Extension	Use counterarguments, summarise another view before responding and moderate a small-group discussion.

Evidence of learning

- I can state and support an opinion on a familiar issue.
- I can ask for clarification and respond to another viewpoint.
- I can write a connected opinion text with clear organisation.
- I can summarise key points from a short discussion or article.

Suggested resources: learner portfolio; teacher-prepared worksheet; visual/audio prompts; CEFR-aligned coursebook selected by the institution (page references to be mapped locally); age-appropriate dictionary; authentic or semi-authentic media.

Integrative project and assessment

The Young English Speakers' Magazine

1. Project brief

Students work as an editorial team to create a multimedia magazine around youth interests and contemporary issues. Each learner researches, writes, revises and presents one substantial contribution and mediates information from at least one source.

2. Project stages

1. Choose a section: society, environment, careers, technology, culture, interviews or lifestyle.
2. Select one or two age-appropriate sources and note the main information.
3. Draft an article, interview, review or advice feature with clear structure.
4. Peer-edit for content, cohesion, language and source attribution.
5. Record or present a short oral companion piece.
6. Publish the class magazine and hold a forum on the strongest recommendations or ideas.

3. Assessment architecture

Assessment moment	Evidence
Diagnostic	A2 integrated check: short narrative, future/experience interview, familiar reading/listening and a 120-word writing sample.
Formative	Learning journals, vocabulary retrieval, pronunciation feedback, paragraph conferences, source-summary checks and discussion observation.
Performance	Podcast story, mock interview, sustainability pitch, media report, cultural presentation and debate contribution.
Summative	B1 integrated task with factual reading/listening, a 180-220 word coherent text and a 4-5 minute oral interaction/presentation.
Portfolio	Six polished unit products, source notes, corrected writing, speaking recording, self-assessment and final magazine contribution.

4. Common performance rubric

Criterion	Observable evidence
Task achievement	Completes the communicative purpose and responds to all essential parts of the task.
Range & accuracy	Uses level-appropriate grammar and vocabulary with errors that do not compromise the intended message.
Coherence	Organises ideas with sequencing and linking appropriate to the level and genre.
Interaction / mediation	Responds, clarifies, reformulates, supports turn-taking and/or relays information appropriately.
Pronunciation / delivery	Speaks intelligibly, using progressively appropriate stress, rhythm and intonation.

Implementation guide

Resources, differentiation, routines and exit indicators

1. Recommended classroom resources

- Learner portfolio: diagnostic sample, drafts, corrected productions, recordings, project evidence and self-assessment.
- Dictionaries: visual/bilingual support at lower levels; increasingly monolingual, collocation and learner dictionaries from B1 upward.
- Coursebook: any institution-approved CEFR-aligned English coursebook; exact page numbers must be mapped after the school selects its edition.
- Worksheets: information gaps, reading/listening organisers, pronunciation grids, peer-feedback checklists, writing frames and reflection sheets.
- Authentic input: menus, maps, notices, websites, podcasts, interviews, short articles, videos and literature adapted to age and level.

2. Lesson routine

Phase	Pedagogical use
Opening	Activate prior knowledge, retrieve previously learned language and connect it explicitly to the lesson purpose.
Input	Notice meaning and form through a short text, audio, image, model dialogue or teacher demonstration.
Guided practice	Rehearse the target language with scaffolds, controlled interaction and pronunciation focus.
Main task	Students use the language to solve a problem, exchange information, create a product or communicate a real message.
Reflection & closure	Students complete an observable "I can..." check, submit an exit ticket or record one piece of evidence in the portfolio.

3. Differentiation model

Pathway	Examples
Support	Visuals, word banks, sentence stems, chunked input, slower audio, guided notes, rehearsal time, peer support and reduced output load.
Core	Independent completion of the expected communicative task using authorised resources and standard time.
Extension	Less scaffolding, wider vocabulary, extra constraints, spontaneous follow-up questions, source comparison, mediation or leadership roles.

4. Exit indicators - Level B1

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| ☐ I can understand the main points of clear standard input on familiar topics. | ☐ I can narrate an experience or story with coherent chronology. |
| ☐ I can write connected texts such as opinions, reports, reviews or personal/professional messages. | ☐ I can explain reasons for plans, opinions and actions. |
| ☐ I can participate actively in familiar discussions and ask for clarification. | ☐ I can summarise or relay the main points of a short text, interview or presentation. |
| ☐ I can deal with common problems in travel, study, work and everyday life. | ☐ I can speak with enough fluency and pronunciation control to be readily understood. |

B1 principle: connected independence - learners should move beyond isolated sentences and sustain coherent meaning across a complete task.